

IAS PRELIMS 2020

STATE BY STATE



WEST BENGAL

DEMOGRAPHICAL

GEOGRAPHICAL

ENVIRONMENTAL

CULTURAL

MODULE - 30

1

HIGHS AND LOWS



1

Formed in 1947 when Bengal was partitioned into East Pakistan (Present Bangladesh), West Bengal (remained with India)

2

Kolkata remained as Country's capital till 1911.

3

Fourth-most populous state in the Country (2011 census)

4

1st Coal mine of India was opened in 1774 at Raniganj.

5

Largest Jute & 2nd Largest Tea producer in India.

6

India's 1st underwater metro rail tunnel proposed in Kolkata through Hugli river.

7

Kolkata is the only city in India where tram service exists

8

Science city of Kolkata is the largest science centre in Indian subcontinent.

STATE BY STATE ... WEST BENGAL

2

BOUNDARIES

1

SIKKIM

4

2

BHUTAN

ASSAM 5

BIHAR 3

BANGLADESH

3

JHARKHAND 2

WEST BENGAL

KOLKATA

ODISHA 1

West Bengal also shares international border with

- ✓ Bangladesh in the East
- ✓ Nepal in the Northwest
- ✓ Bhutan in the North

STATE BOUNDARY

INTERNATIONAL BOUNDARY

West Bengal is located in Eastern India and bordered by Indian States of

- ✓ Sikkim to the North
- ✓ Bihar and Jharkhand to the West
- ✓ Odisha to the Southwest
- ✓ Assam to the Northeast

STATE BY STATE ... WEST BENGAL

3

REGIONS

Malda

Jalpaiguri

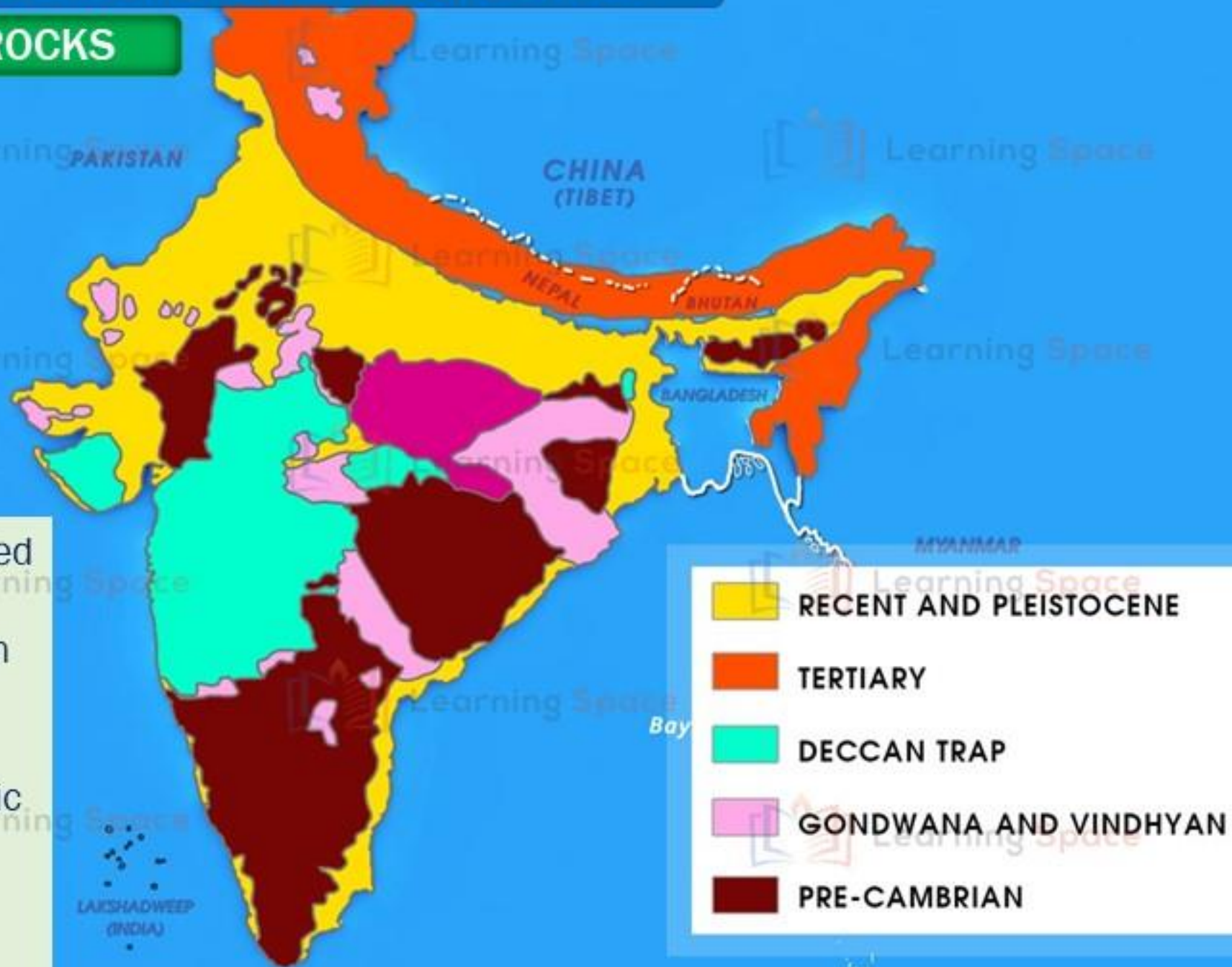
Burdwan

Medinipur

Presidency

West Bengal comprises of 23 districts which are grouped under five divisions for administrative purposes:

- ✓ Presidency division
- ✓ Medinipur division
- ✓ Burdwan division
- ✓ Malda division
- ✓ Jalpaiguri division



- Most of the basin area is covered by alluvium.
- Gondwana rocks are exposed in the western part as outliers on the Archean basement
- Other exposures include basaltic rocks, known as the Rajmahal Trap, lying over the Gondwana sediments.

RELIEF FEATURES



Terai

Northern Mountain

- Northern Himalayan Mountain region: Darjeeling hills are part of Eastern Himalayan range.
- Narrow Terai region separates hills from North Bengal plains.
- Bengal plains are formed by depositions of Ganga-Brahmaputra river system.
- Rahr or Rarh region is the area between Chota Nagpur plateau and Ganges delta and is made of old alluvial deposits.
- Western plateau is Eastward extension of Chota Nagpur plateau.
- Sunderbans delta form the mangrove ecosystem

Plains

Rahr

Western Plateau

Coastal Fringe

Sunderbans

DRAINAGE SYSTEM

BIHAR

BANGLADESH



TEESTA

- Originates in the glaciers of North Sikkim.
- Enters West Bengal at Rangpoo and upto Mechi, it forms the boundary between West Bengal and Sikkim.
- Two of its tributaries-Great Rangit and Rammam also serve as the natural boundary between the two states.
- Finally drains into Brahmaputra in Bangladesh.

HUGLI RIVER

- Ganga splits into Hugli at Giria.
- Most of the water to Hugli is provided by Farakka feeder canal
- River's lower reaches are fed by the Ajay, Damodar, Rupnarayan rivers.

GANGA

- Divides into two branches.
- One branch enters into Bangladesh as Padma
- Others branch flows into West Bengal as Hooghly or Hugli.
- Farakka barrage on Ganga feeds Hooghly branch of river by a feeder canal

STATE BY STATE ... WEST BENGAL

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DRAINAGE SYSTEM

MAHANANDA

- Originates from Ghoom near Darjeeling.
- Bounded on the North by the Himalayas, in the East by ridges separating it from Teesta river system, River Ganga on the South.
- Drains into the Ganga at Godogarighat just downstream of the point where Ganga leaves the boundary of West Bengal.



DAMODAR

- Flows through Jharkhand, West Bengal
- Tributaries are Barakar, Konar, Bokaro and Ayar.
- Second-longest river of west Bengal.
- Damodar and Barakar together trifurcates Chota Nagpur plateau.
- Earlier known as "Sorrow of Bengal" due to floods created by it but with the Damodar Valley Project, the floods have been controlled.

RUPNARAYAN

- Originates from the foothills of Chotanagpur plateau and falls into Hooghly river at Geonkhali in West Bengal.
- River is known as Dwarakeswar river in Bankura district.
- Rup Narayan river originates as a combined flow of the Silabati and Dwarakeswar rivers

STATE BY STATE ... WEST BENGAL

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DRAINAGE SYSTEM - DAMS

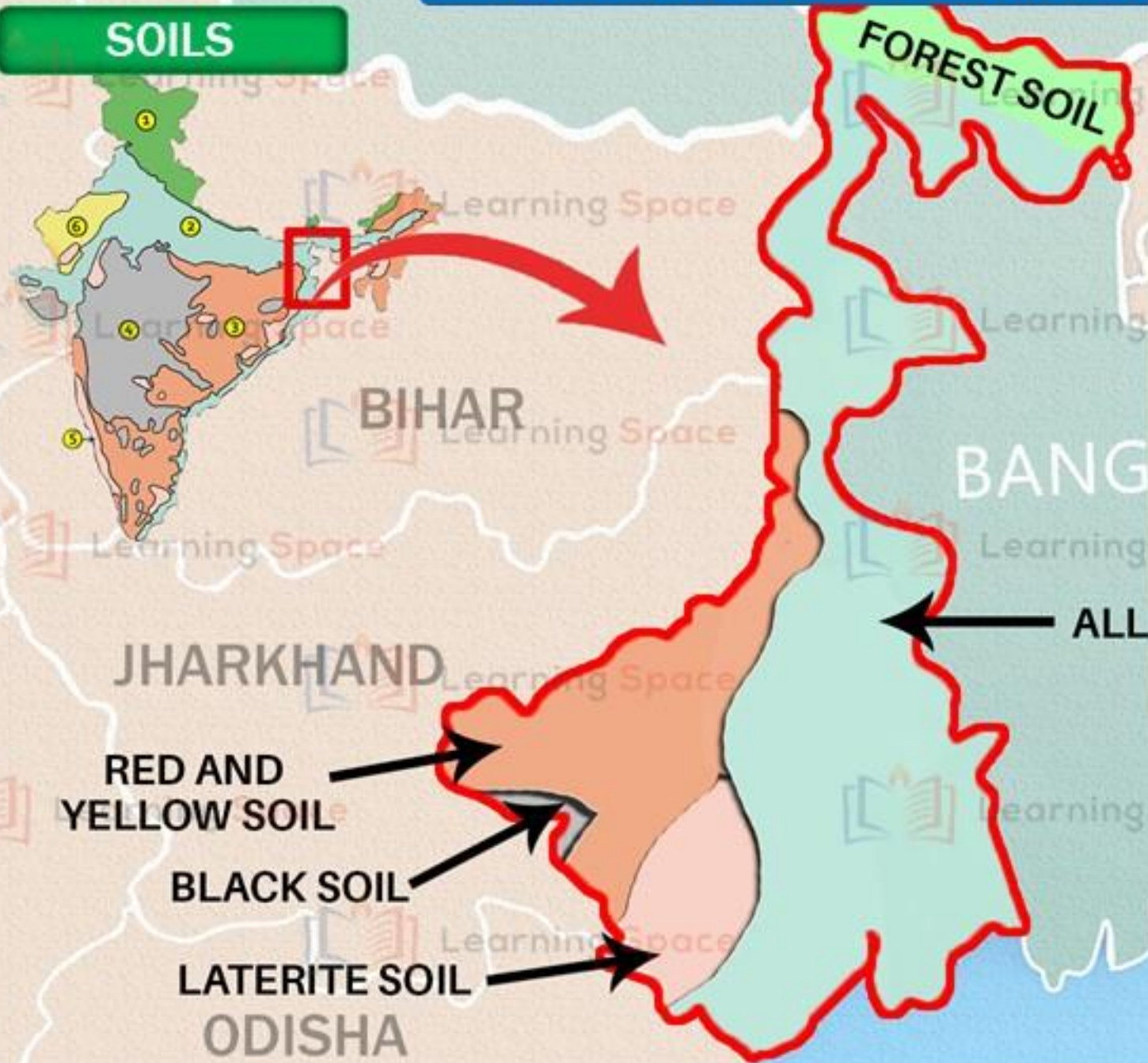


- Durgapur Barrage, built on Damodar river, provides water for purpose of irrigation and fulfills water needs of industrial town of Durgapur
- Farakka Barrage diverts adequate quantity of Ganga waters to Bhagirathi-Hoogly river system
- Farakka water sharing treaty was also signed between India and Bangladesh over sharing of Ganga waters at Farakka.

STATE BY STATE ... WEST BENGAL

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SOILS



- Northern region of West Bengal has Mountain soil, which is less fertile and black in color and suitable for tea, pineapple, oranges cultivation.
- Region below the mountains, i.e. doars are thick forests that consist of forest soil.
- Alluvial soil is present along banks of Ganga.
- Laterite soil is found in the Western plateau region and infertile
- Sundarbans and coastal areas of the State have saline soil which is bluish, acidic, suitable only for plantation crops.

1. Forest Soil
2. Alluvial Soil
3. Red and Yellow Soil
4. Black Soil
5. Laterite Soil
6. Arid Soil

NORTHEAST MONSOON



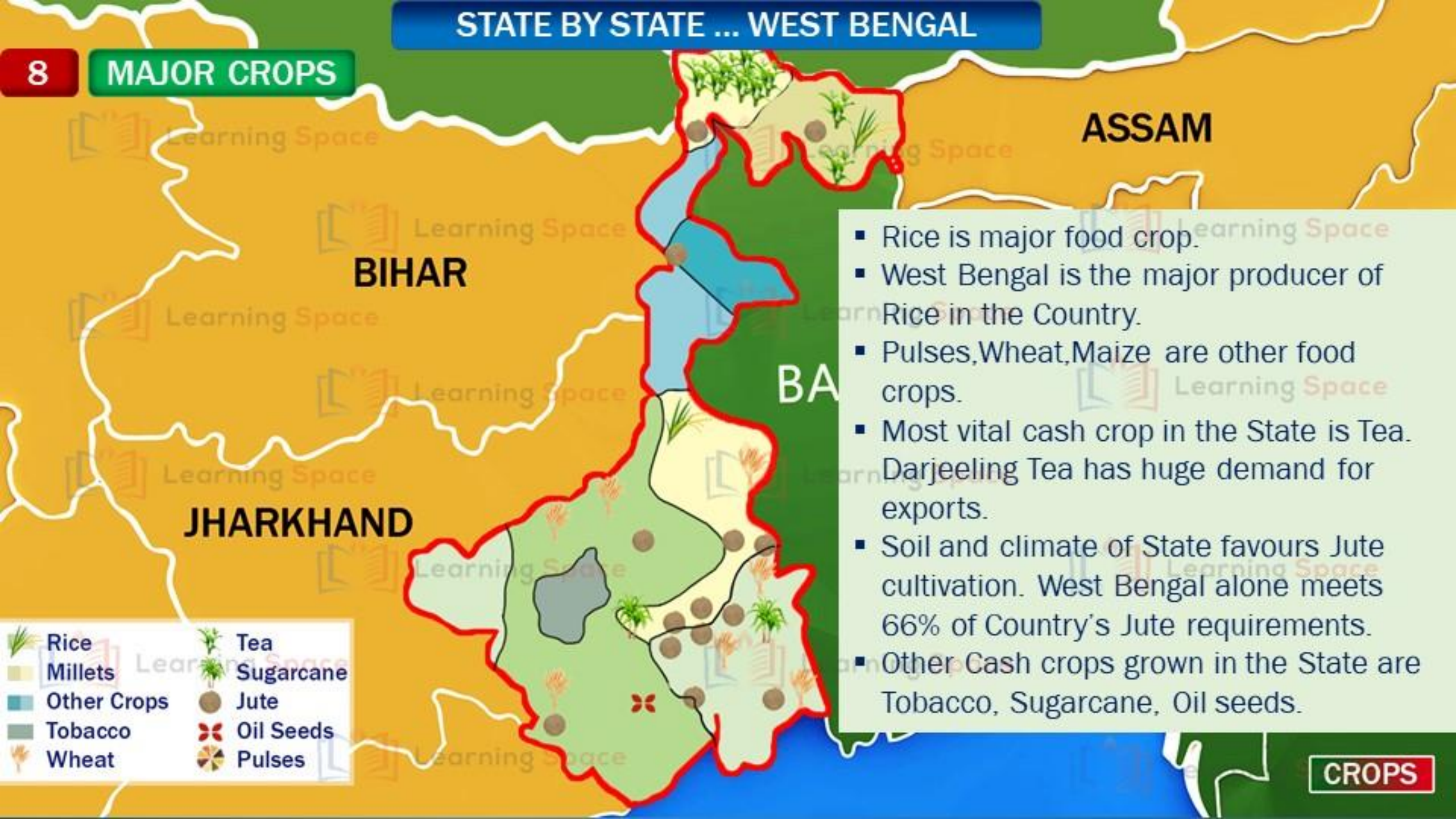
SOUTHWEST MONSOON

- State experiences a tropical monsoon type of climate
- Kalbaisakhi or Norwesters are localized weather phenomenon in West Bengal which brings speedy winds, torrential rainfall and thunderstorms.
- West Bengal receives Bay of Bengal branch of the Southwest monsoon between June-September.
- Rainfall is heavy in Darjeeling, Jalpaiguri and Cooch Behar regions and experience a cool temperate climate.
- Western plateau is comparatively dry
- During Monsoon, low pressure in West Bengal often leads to storms in Coastal areas.

STATE BY STATE ... WEST BENGAL

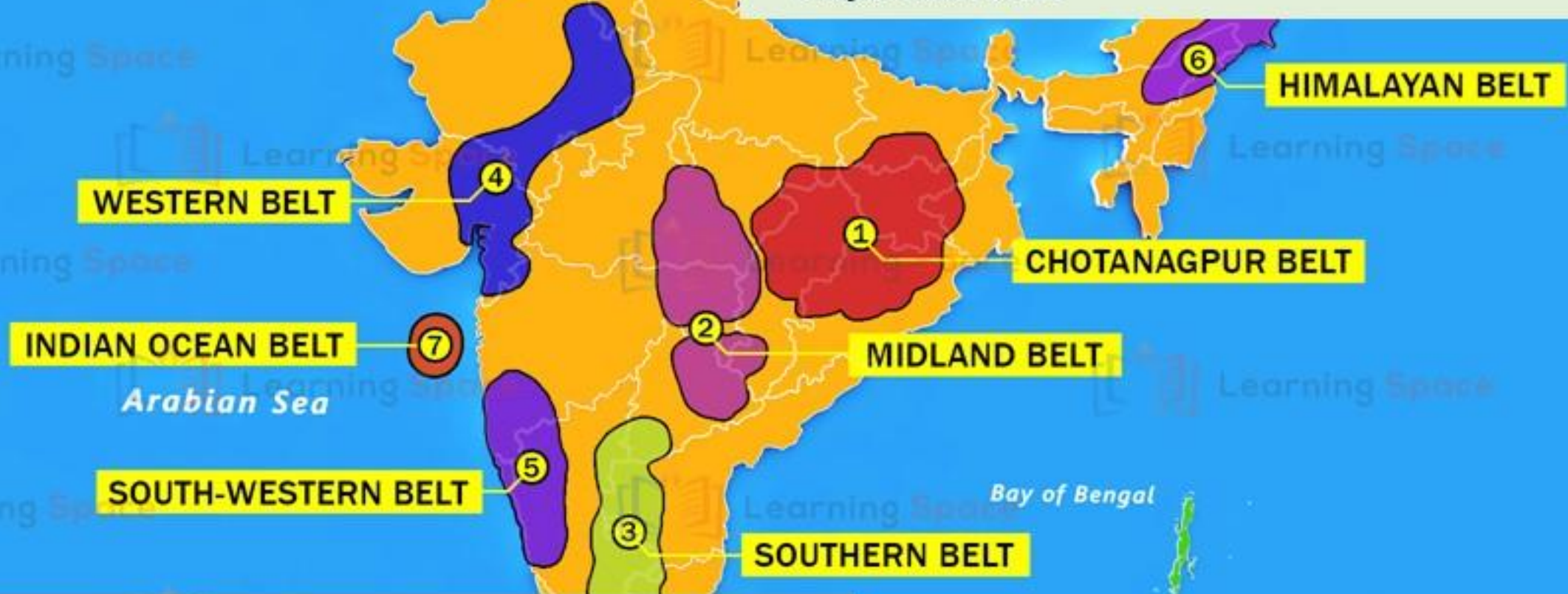
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MAJOR CROPS



MINERAL BELTS IN INDIA

- Since West Bengal lies in the Chota Nagpur mineral belt, it has rich mineral sources
- Coal is the most extracted mineral in the State.
- Raniganj, Barjora, Jamuria, Ramnagar are the major coalfields.



- Iron-ore is found in Purulia, Darjeeling, Bankura districts
- Other minerals like Manganese, Fireclay, Copper, Limestone are also found in minor quantity.

STATE BY STATE ... WEST BENGAL

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INFRASTRUCTURE ... POWER PLANTS



10 INFRASTRUCTURE ... PORTS

KOLKATA PORT

- Recently Kolkata port trust was renamed as Dr.Syama Prasad Mukherjee Port trust.
- only riverine port in the Country.
- It was an important port during British rule to ship off Indian laborers to other countries to work in plantations.

BANGLADESH

ASSAM

JHARKHAND

SEA PORTS

Kolkata Port

Haldia Port

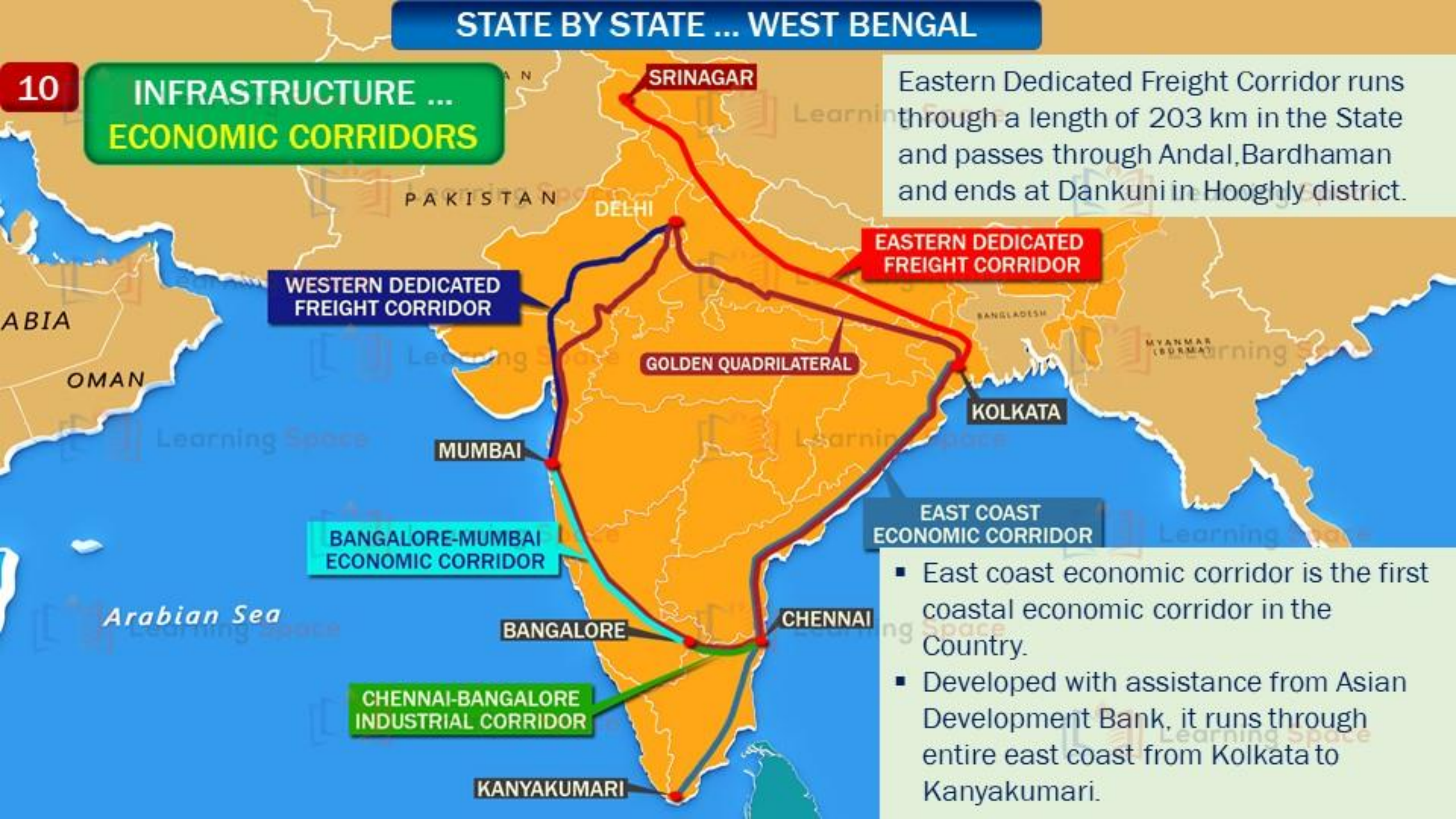
HALDIA PORT

- Built at the meeting point of Haldi river and Hooghly river.
- Haldia port's vast hinterland comprises of Northeastern states, Nepal, Bhutan, Tibet region.

STATE BY STATE ... WEST BENGAL

10

INFRASTRUCTURE ... ECONOMIC CORRIDORS



Eastern Dedicated Freight Corridor runs through a length of 203 km in the State and passes through Andal, Bardhaman and ends at Dankuni in Hooghly district.

**EASTERN DEDICATED
FREIGHT CORRIDOR**

**WESTERN DEDICATED
FREIGHT CORRIDOR**

GOLDEN QUADRILATERAL

KOLKATA

**EAST COAST
ECONOMIC CORRIDOR**

**BANGALORE-MUMBAI
ECONOMIC CORRIDOR**

BANGALORE

CHENNAI

**CHENNAI-BANGALORE
INDUSTRIAL CORRIDOR**

KANYAKUMARI

- East coast economic corridor is the first coastal economic corridor in the Country.
- Developed with assistance from Asian Development Bank, it runs through entire east coast from Kolkata to Kanyakumari.

STATE BY STATE ... WEST BENGAL

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INFRASTRUCTURE ... OIL REFINERY



ASSAM

BIHAR

BANGLADESH

JHARKHAND

HALDIA

OIL REFINERIES

- Haldia Oil refinery has two sectors-One for producing fuel products and other for lube based stocks.
- Fuel sector was built with French collaboration and the Lube sector with Romanian collaboration.



BIHAR

ASSAM

BANGLADESH

JHARKHAND

IISCO Steel Plant

Durgapur Steel Plant

- Durgapur Steel plant was setup with the help of U.K and is situated on the banks of Damodar river.
- IISCO steel plant is located in Asansol.
- Earlier it was Indian Iron and steel company, later amalgamated with SAIL in 2006 and became IISCO.

STATE BY STATE ... WEST BENGAL

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INFRASTRUCTURE ... NATIONAL WATERWAY



National Waterway 1

Sahibganj

BANGLADESH

Jharkhand

West Bengal

Haldia

Uttar Pradesh

Prayagraj

Varanasi

Bihar

NEPAL

CHINA

BHUTAN

- NW-1 also known as Ganga-Bhagirathi-Hooghly river system.
- Longest waterway in India.
- Covers 4 States
 - ✓ Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Jharkhand, West Bengal

STATE BY STATE ... WEST BENGAL

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INFRASTRUCTURE ... URJA GANGA PIPELINE

UTTAR PRADESH

Lucknow

Jagdishpur

Phulpur

Varanasi

Patna

Barauni

Gaya

JHARKHAND

Ranchi

Bokaro

Sindri

Durgapur

Jamshedpur

Rourkela

WEST BENGAL

Haldia

Kolkata

Sambalpur

Angul

ODISHA

Bhubaneswar

Cuttack

Dhamra

Paradip

- Passes through 5 states

- ✓ Uttar Pradesh

- ✓ Bihar

- ✓ Jharkhand

- ✓ Odisha and

- ✓ West Bengal

- Objectives:

- ✓ Provide Piped cooking gas to households in Eastern India

- ✓ Provides CNG for vehicles

- ✓ Clean fuel for industries

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NATIONAL PARKS

- Singalila NP is located on Singalila ridge at a high altitude in Darjeeling district and trekking route to Sandakphu(highest peak in W.B)runs through NP.
- Neora valley NP borders Sikkim and Bhutan and is home to Red Panda

Singalila NP

Neora Valley NP

Buxa Tiger Reserve

ASSAM

Jaldapara NP

TORSA RIVER

Gorumara NP

RAIDAK RIVER

Jaldapara NP is famous for one-horned rhinoceros.

BIHAR

BANGLADESH

AND

Sundarbans NP

→ RIVER FLOWING THROUGH
■ RIVER FLOWING BY
NP - NATIONAL PARK

STATE BY STATE ... WEST BENGAL

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WILDLIFE SANCTUARIES

- Mahananda WLS, located at Himalayan foothills between Teesta and Mahananda rivers is famous for protection of Indian Bison and Royal Bengal Tiger.
- Dalma WLS extends between Jharkhand and West Bengal.

Other WLS in West Bengal are

- Bethuadahari WLS
- Bibhuthibhushan WLS
- Chapramari WLS
- Haliday Island WLS
- Senchal WLS

JHARKHAND

BANGLAD

ASSAM

Mahananda

Buxa

Ramnabagan

Bethuadahari

Dalma

Sajnakhali

West Sundarban

Lothian Island

WLS - WILDLIFE SANCTUARY

STATE BY STATE ... WEST BENGAL

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RAMSAR WETLANDS

EAST CALCUTTA WETLANDS

- Combination of natural and manmade wetlands;
- Treats Kolkata's sewage
- Hosts largest sewage fed aquaculture in the world
- Designated as Ramsar wetland in 2002

BIHAR

BANGLA

JHARKHAND

East Calcutta

Sunderbans

WETLANDS

ASSAM

BIHAR

JHARKHAND

BA

SUNDARBANS

- Designated as UNESCO WHS, National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Biosphere reserve.
- Mangroves in the delta formed by the confluence of the Ganges, Brahmaputra and Meghna Rivers.
- Extends from Hooghly river in West Bengal to Baleswar river in Bangladesh.
- Name Sundarbans is derived from "Sundri/Sundari" trees which are the major plant species in the region.
- Sundarbans is the World's largest coastal mangrove ecosystem.
- Famous Novels Midnight Children (Salman Rushdie), The Hungry Tide (Amitav Ghosh) are set in the backdrop of Sundarbans.

BR - BIOSPHERE RESERVES

SUNDARBANS

SUNDARBANS TIGER RESERVE

- Home to large population of Royal Bengal Tiger
- Sundarban is isolated with no forest connection to other tiger-occupied mainlands.
- Hence pressure on forest resources, incidents of human-wildlife conflict are high.

Buxa

BUXA TIGER RESERVE

- Northern boundary of reserve runs along the international border with Bhutan
- Phipsu Wildlife Sanctuary of Bhutan is contiguous to the North of Buxa Tiger Reserve.
- Recently Buxa Reserve was identified by NTCA for tiger augmentation program.

Sundarbans

TIGER RESERVES

STATE BY STATE ... WEST BENGAL

16

ELEPHANT RESERVES

- Eastern Doars ER belongs to North Bengal- Greater Manas Landscape.
- Doars are the stretch of alluvial flood plains around River Teesta
- Mayurjharna ER belongs to East-Central Landscape

EASTERN DOOARS ER

ASSAM

BANGLADESH

JHARKHAND

WEST BENGAL

MAYURJHARNA ER

ODISHA

MYAN
(BUR)

ELEPHANT RESERVES

STATE BY STATE ... WEST BENGAL

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UNESCO - WHS



Darjeeling Mountain Railway

DARJEELING MOUNTAIN RAILWAY

- Also known as Toy train
- Runs between New Jalpaiguri and Darjeeling covering a distance of 78km.
- Runs on a 2ft railway gauge.
- Ghum is the highest altitude station on the railway track.
- Designated as WHS in 1999.
- Together with Nilgiri mountain railway, Kalka-Shimla Railway, the three mountain railways hold UNESCO WHS tag.

JHARKHAND

BANG



Sundarbans National Park

WHS - WORLD HERITAGE SITES

PUTUL NAACH



- Form of Rod Puppetry in West Bengal
- Putul is a word that describes both a doll and a puppet in Bengali while Naach means Dance.
- Other Traditional forms of puppetry found in West Bengal are Rod (Dang), Glove (Beni or Bene) and String (Taar or Shuto).

BAUL



- Folk music of Bengal
- Unique to West Bengal and Bangladesh.
- Baul means "afflicted with the wind disease"
- Baul singers are mostly people who travel alone carrying musical instruments.
- Lyrics in Baul music urge man to search for God within himself (Similar to Sufi music)

GANGA SAGAR MELA



- Second most popular mela after Kumbhmela.
- Held in Sagar island.
- Has cultural, spiritual significance.
- As part of Mela, Pilgrims dip themselves in the holy waters of Ganga to purify their souls.
- Held on the day of Makar Sankranti.

CHHAU



- Purulia Chhau is the Version of Chhau performed in West Bengal
- Masks form an integral part of this dance.
- Chhau masks of Purulia holds GI tag
- Dance is a mix of martial, tribal, folk traditions.
- Chhau dance was inscribed in the UNESCO's Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity in 2010.

BIRHOR



- Found in States of WB, Jharkand, Orissa, Chattisgarh.
- Bir means 'Jungle' and hor means 'Men'. Birhors are jungle people.
- Claim themselves as descendants of Sun.

LODHA



- In States of WB, Odisha
- Few sections of Lodha population converted to Islam and became Lodha Muslims.
- Once treated as criminal tribe but later denotified.

TOTO



- Isolated tribal group living in small enclave of Totopara near the border of West Bengal and Bhutan on banks of Torsa river.
- Follow endogamy.

RED PANDA



- **IUCN: EN**
- Small arboreal mammal found in the forests of India, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and southern China
- Singalila and Neora National parks are best places to sight this animal in West Bengal.

ROYAL BENGAL TIGER



- **IUCN: EN**
- National animal of India.
- *Panthera Tigris* is its scientific name
- Threatened by poaching, hunting, illegal smuggling of body parts.
- Sundarbans NP is the best place to sight Bengal Tiger.

NAKSHI KANTHA



- Type of embroidered quilt
- Naksha in Bengali refers to artistic patterns.
- Running stitch called “Kantha stitch” is the main stitch used in this embroidery.

GOBINDOBHOG, TULAPANJI RICE



- Two rice varieties of Bengal famous for their unique aroma, quality.
- Tulapanji is non-Basmati, long grain, aromatic rice.
- Gobhindobhog is a short grain, sticky rice with a sweet-buttery flavor.

RECENT NEWS-GI TAGS

MADUR KATHI



- Mats woven from a reed called Madur kottir or Madurkathi
- Mats are woven predominantly by Mahishya caste women.
- Mats are non-conductive, sweat absorbing making them ideal for Bengal's humid climate

DARJEELING TEA



- First GI-tagged product in India.
- Black, White and green varieties of Darjeeling tea have GI tag.
- According to the Tea Board, Darjeeling tea cannot be grown or manufactured anywhere else in the world except in Darjeeling, Kalimpong regions.

KANYASHREE PRAKALPA SCHEME



- West Bengal Government's most commended initiative for welfare of girl child.
- A conditional cash transfer is made to bank account in the name of girl child to incentivize schooling, delay child marriages of girls.
- UN has awarded West Bengal Government first place in Public service for implementing the scheme

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